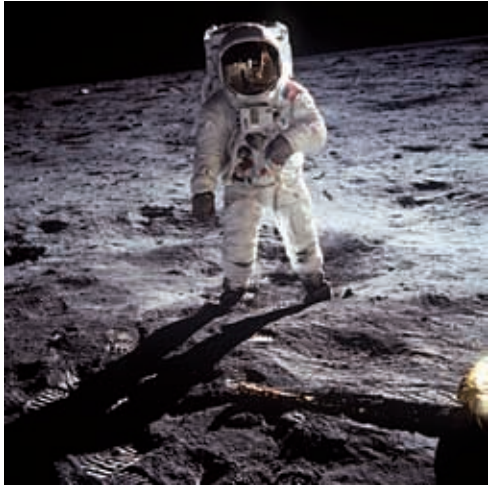


solar panels, positioned to face towards the east and west. The unit had a total mass of 48 kg.

The EASEP was deployed approximately 17 metres south of the Eagle, and was turned on by ground command while the astronauts were still on the surface. About 5 hours before local lunar sunset on August 3, 1969 – well after the astronauts had left – transmission was stopped by ground command when the power began to drop as predicted. Despite operating temperatures which exceeded the planned maximum, the EASEP functioned normally. The instrument was turned on again on the next lunar day but on August 27, 1969, near noon of this second lunar day, the EASEP no longer accepted commands from Earth stations and the experiment was terminated.



Buzz Aldrin poses for what is arguably the most famous photo of man on the moon. In his visor, you can see a reflection of Neil Armstrong clicking the photograph

After taking two core tube samples of lunar soil, Aldrin returned to the LM first, after 1 hour 41 minutes on the lunar surface. Armstrong followed about 12 minutes later, after transferring the sample boxes up to Aldrin and placing a packet of memorial items on the ground. The duo spent the next seven hours resting and checking out systems.

The Eagle lifted off from the moon at 17:54:01 on July 21, after 21 hours, 36 minutes on the lunar surface. After docking with the CSM, the Eagle was jettisoned into lunar orbit. The fate of the LM is not known, but it's assumed to have crashed into the lunar surface sometime in the following few months.

The journey back began on July 21, and after successfully leaving the lunar orbit, the astronauts slept for about 10 hours. After a small midcourse correction, re-entry procedures into Earth were initiated on July 24 – 44 hours after leaving lunar orbit.